

Tax & Depreciation Essentials Checklist — Investors (South Australia)

What to have in place, and what's changing, before you lodge your next return.

Correct as at July 2026. General information only — this is NOT financial, tax or legal advice. Always engage a qualified accountant or tax agent for advice specific to your situation.

Section 1 — Records to Keep From Day One

- ☐ ☐ **A tax depreciation schedule from a qualified quantity surveyor** — Division 43 (building) and Division 40 (plant and equipment) deductions.
- ☐ ☐ **Receipts for repairs vs. improvements — kept separately.** Repairs are often immediately deductible; improvements form part of your CGT cost base.
- ☐ ☐ **RevenueSA land tax assessments** — keep every annual assessment.
- ☐ ☐ **Stamp duty receipts.**
- ☐ ☐ **Records of your accountant fees and depreciation schedule costs.**

Section 2 — South Australia Land Tax Obligations

- ☐ ☐ **Check whether you're above the threshold.** Land tax applies where your taxable SA land value exceeds approximately **\$833,000** for individual ownership.
- ☐ ☐ **Understand the trust threshold is dramatically lower.** If your property is held in a trust, the threshold is just **\$25,000** — meaning almost any trust-held investment property in SA attracts land tax. This is the single most important structural fact for SA property investors to understand before choosing an ownership vehicle.
- ☐ ☐ **Model the real cost difference before deciding on a trust structure.** A \$1 million property held in a trust costs roughly \$5,000/year in land tax, versus around \$835/year held individually — this gap compounds significantly over a multi-year hold.
- ☐ ☐ **If you're a foreign entity, budget for the 7% foreign ownership surcharge** at purchase.
- ☐ ☐ **Note that SA indexes its land tax thresholds** — SA is one of only two states (alongside NSW, which recently froze its thresholds) that has actively adjusted thresholds for property value growth, so figures here should be reconfirmed for the current year rather than assumed static long-term.

Section 3 — Understanding the Changing CGT Environment

- ☐ ☐ **Be aware Commonwealth CGT settings for investment property are changing**, with reforms affecting the CGT discount generally applying from **1 July 2027** — confirm the finalised current position with your accountant.
- ☐ ☐ **If planning to sell, get advice on timing relative to the 2027 changeover.**

Section 4 — Depreciation Schedule Timing

- ☐ ☐ **Get your depreciation schedule prepared as early as possible after settlement.**
- ☐ ☐ **Update it after any renovations or major asset additions.**
- ☐ ☐ **Don't assume an older SA property has no deductions available** — plant and equipment deductions can still apply.

Section 5 — Questions to Bring to Your Accountant

- ☐ ☐ What is my current SA land tax position, and would an individual vs. trust ownership structure make a material difference for this specific property?
- ☐ ☐ Does the foreign ownership surcharge apply to my situation?
- ☐ ☐ How will the 2027 CGT changes affect a future sale of this property?
- ☐ ☐ Is my depreciation schedule up to date with any renovations or asset purchases since it was last prepared?

Quick Reference — SA Investor Tax Snapshot (July 2026)

ITEM	DETAIL
Land tax threshold (individuals)	~\$833,000
Land tax threshold (trusts)	\$25,000
Foreign ownership surcharge	7% at purchase
CGT discount changes	Cost-base indexation + minimum tax from 1 July 2027
Depreciation schedule	Div 40 (plant/equipment) + Div 43 (building) — quantity surveyor required

© HouseHQ. General information only, current as at the date shown. This is not financial, tax or legal advice. Always engage a qualified accountant or registered tax agent for advice specific to your circumstances.

